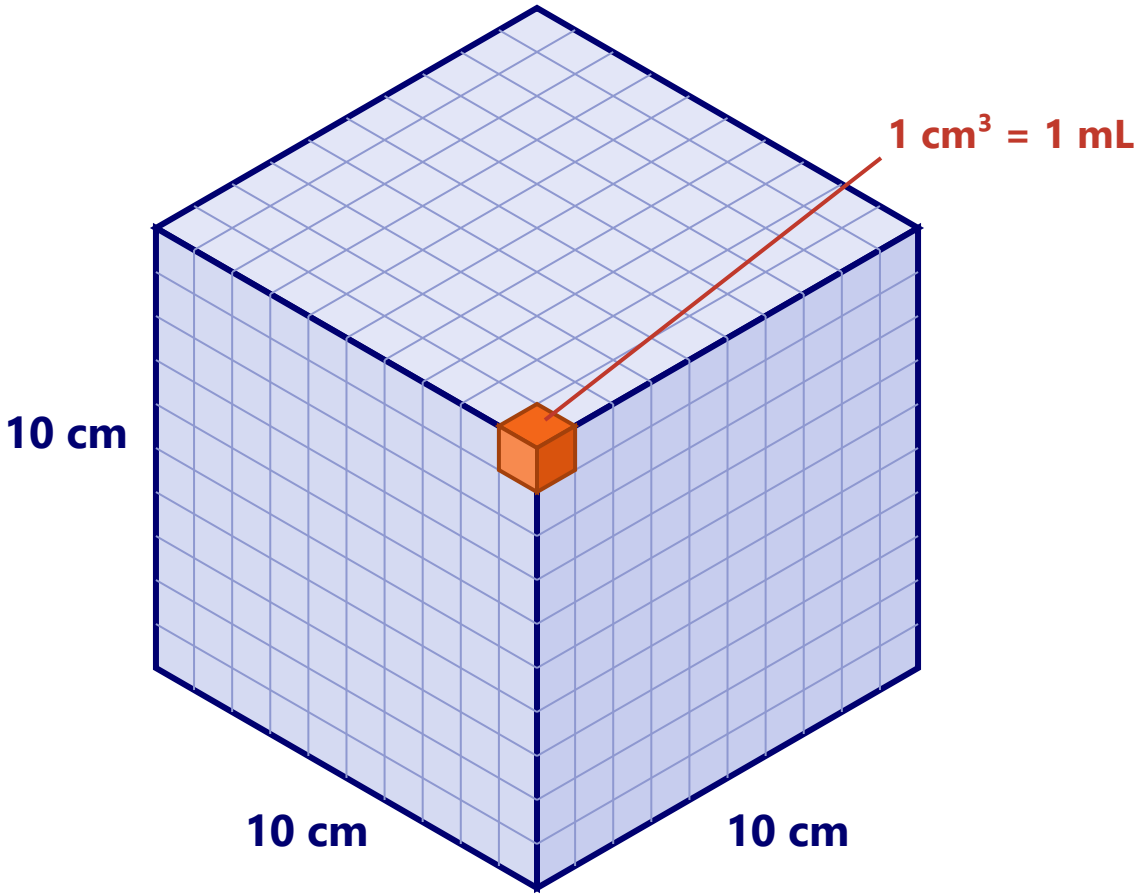
Cubic units: why the factor is cubed (and what a litre is)



The big cube has sides of **1 dm = 10 cm**.
Its volume is **1 dm³**: exactly **1 litre**.

It holds 10 × 10 × 10 small cubes of **1 cm³**:
$1\ dm^3 = (10\ cm)^3 = \mathbf{10^3\ cm^3} = 1000\ cm^3$

1 m³	=	**1 kL**	= 1000 L
1 dm³	=	**1 L**	= 1000 mL
1 cm³	=	**1 mL**	